

V01 ACTIVE BUILDINGS AND COMMUNITIES | P

Intent : Facilitate all types of movement, including physical activity and exercise and reduce sedentary behavior through the intentional design of built spaces.

Summary : This WELL feature requires projects to select from a series of design-based optimizations.

Issue : Physical inactivity is linked to premature mortality and chronic diseases, including type II diabetes, cardiovascular disease, depression, stroke, dementia and some forms of cancer.¹⁻³ Despite widely disseminated physical activity guidelines (Appendix V1), global estimates from 2016 show that nearly a quarter (23%) of the adult population are physically inactive.³ In addition, our homes, schools, workplaces, communities, jobs and transportation systems have been physically designed to demand less movement and require more sedentary activities.^{3,4}

Solutions : We have come to understand that our environments play a significant role in physical activity behaviors.^{2,5-10} Active design considers how different components of a building, such as staircases can encourage movement.¹¹ At a community scale, active design considers the ways in which communities can encourage populations to be active through public infrastructure, such as cycle lanes and green space. These factors, beyond physical activity promotion, also positively impact environmental, social and economic outcomes.^{11,12} The impact of changing the global physical activity narrative is substantial. Worldwide, if physical inactivity were reduced by just 10%, more than half a million deaths could be averted, while over one million deaths could be averted, if physical inactivity were reduced by 25%.¹³

PART 1 DESIGN ACTIVE BUILDINGS AND COMMUNITIES

For All Spaces:

The project achieves at least one point in one of the following features:

- a.
 - Feature V03: Circulation Network.
- b. Feature V04: Facilities for Active Occupants.
- c.
 - Feature V05: Site Planning and Selection.
- d.
 - Feature V08: Physical Activity Spaces and Equipment.

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